

Pronunciation Guide

The tables provide sample words to explain the sounds associated with specific letters and letter combinations used in the respellings in this book. For example, *a* represents the short “a” sound in *cat*, while *ay* represents the long “a” sound in *day*.

Letter combinations are used to approximate certain more complex sounds. For example, in the respelling of *trapezoid*—TRA-puh-zoyd—the letters *uh* represent the vowel sound you hear in *shut* and *other*.

VOWELS

a	short a: apple , cat
ay	long a: cane , day
e, eh	short e: hen , bed
ee	long e: feed , team
i, ih	short i: lip , active
iy	long i: try , might
ah	short o: hot , father
oh	long o: home , throw
uh	short u: shut , other
yoo	long u: union , cute

LETTER COMBINATIONS

ch	chin , ancient
sh	show , mission
zh	vision , azure
th	thin , health
th	then , heather
ur	bird , further , word
us	bus , crust
or	court , formal
ehr	error , care
oo	cool , true , rule
ow	now , out
ou	look , pull , would
oy	coin , toy
aw	saw , maul , fall
ng	song , finger
air	Aristotle , barrister
ahr	cart , martyr

CONSONANTS

b	butter , baby
d	dog , cradle
f	fun , phone
g	grade , angle
h	hat , ahead
j	judge , gorge
k	kite , car , black
l	lily , mile
m	mom , camel
n	next , candid
p	price , copper
r	rubber , free
s	small , circle , hassle
t	ton , pottery
v	vase , vivid
w	wall , away
y	yellow , kayak
z	zebra , haze